- Permitting the Small Industries Development Bank (SIDBI) as an eligible borrower for accessing ECB for on-lending to the micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs); and
- Permitting the National Housing Bank (NHB)/Housing Finance Companies to avail themselves of ECBs for financing prospective owners of low cost /affordable housing units.

RGESS

On *November 23, 2012*, the government notified a new tax saving scheme called the Rajiv Gandhi Equity Savings Scheme (RGESS), ***exclusively for first-time retail investors*** in the securities market. This scheme provides 50 per cent deduction of the amount invested from taxable income for that year to new investors who invest up to Rs. 50,000 and whose annual income is below Rs. 10 lakh.The Rajiv Gandhi Equity Saving Scheme (RGESS) will give tax benefits to new investors whose annual income is up to Rs. 10 lakh for investments up to a maximum of Rs. 50,000. The investor will get 50 per cent deduction of the amount invested from taxable income for that year. Salient features of the scheme are as follows –

- The scheme is open to new retail investors identified on the basis of their permanent account numbers (PAN).
- The tax deduction allowed will be over and above the Rs. 1 lakh limit permitted allowed under Section 80 C of the IncomeTax Act.
- In addition to the 50 per cent tax deduction for investments, dividend income is also tax free.
- Stocks listed under BSE 100 or CNX 100, or stocks of public-sector undertakings (PSUs) that are Navratnas, Maharatnas, and Miniratnas will be eligible under the scheme. Follow-on public offers (FPOs) of these companies will also be eligible.
- IPOs of PSUs, which are scheduled to get listed in the relevant financial year and whose annual turnover is not less than Rs. 4,000 crore for each of the immediate past three years, will also be eligible.